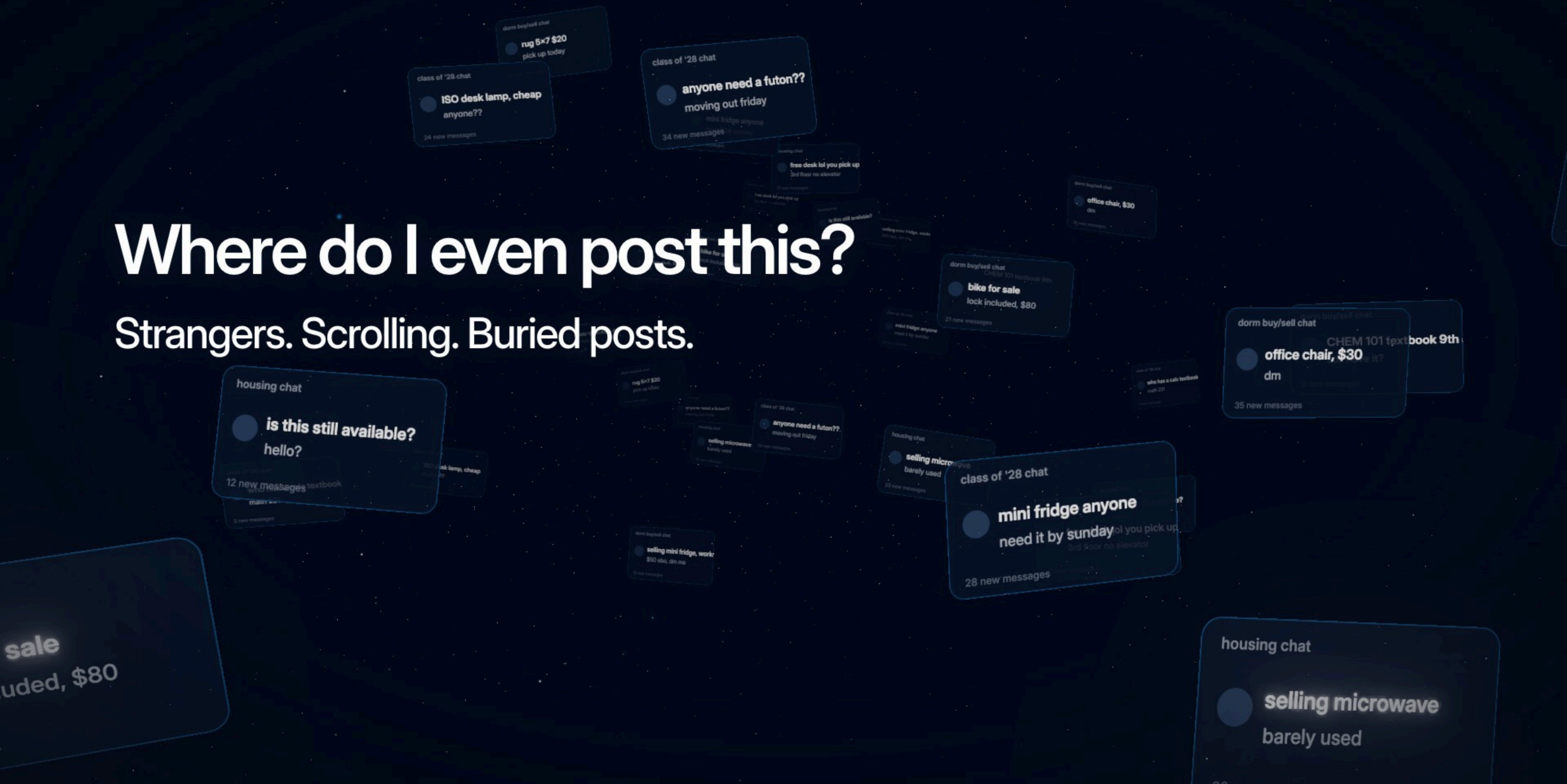


karl

the campus marketplace that lives in iMessage

Where do I even post this?

Strangers. Scrolling. Buried posts.



Tell Karl once. He does the looking.



Karl texts *you* when the thing you want shows up.

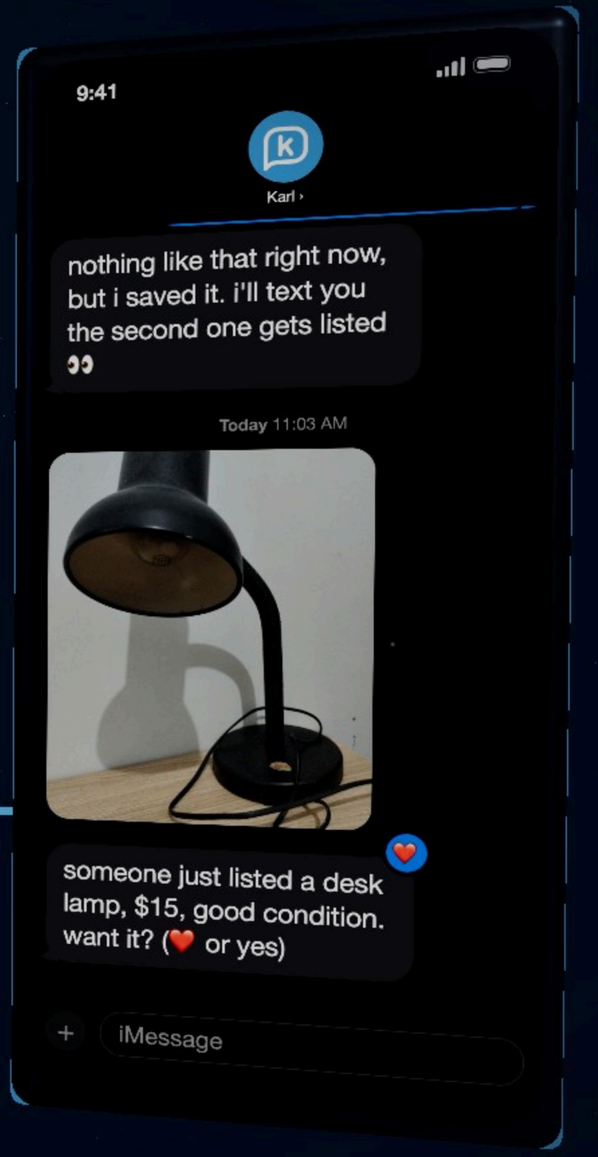
Ask once. Karl keeps looking.

wed 11:03 am

need a desk lamp under $20

JUST LISTED
desk lamp
$15

tue night · overnight · wed morning



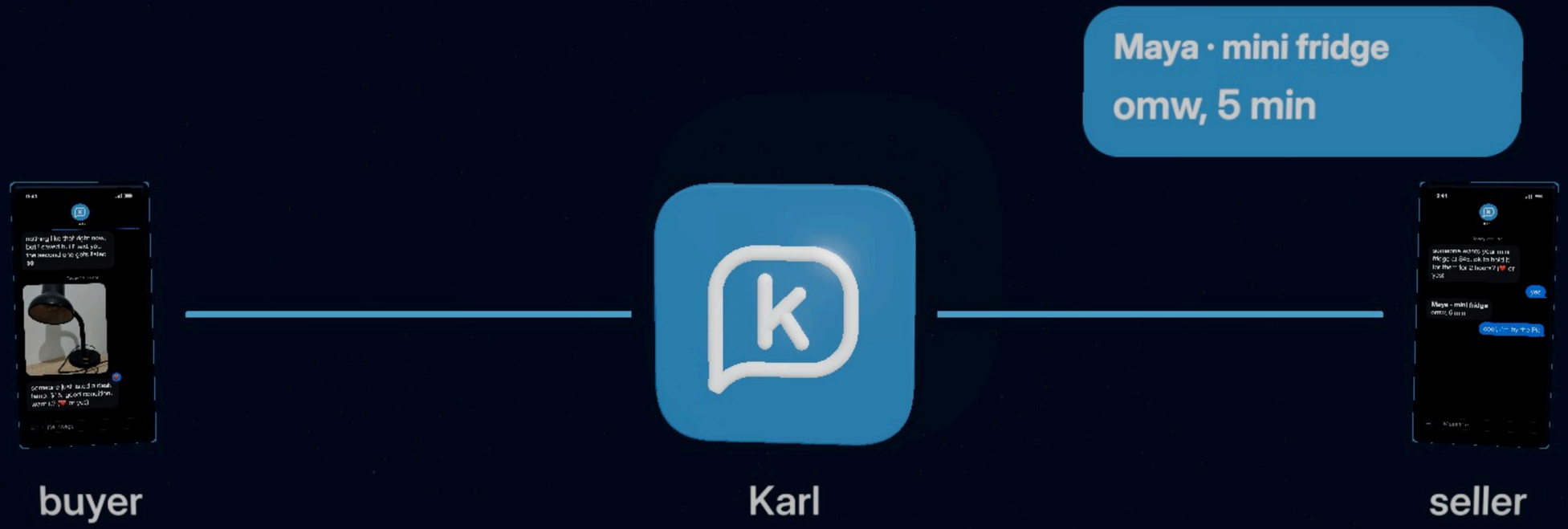
your want becomes a standing semantic search · every new listing is matched against it

Let's try it.

live demo



Nobody's number gets shared.



masked relay · two 1:1 threads bridged by Karl · rules route first, an intent model breaks ties

Karl haggles for you.

deal · $40

Karl

offer → counter → deal
a deal state machine: nothing commits until both sides say yes



Every message gets scanned.

heads up: only pay once you actually have the item

blocked





buyer

Karl

seller

pay first · deposits · pressure → **Karl warns**

numbers · links · gift cards · crypto → blocked

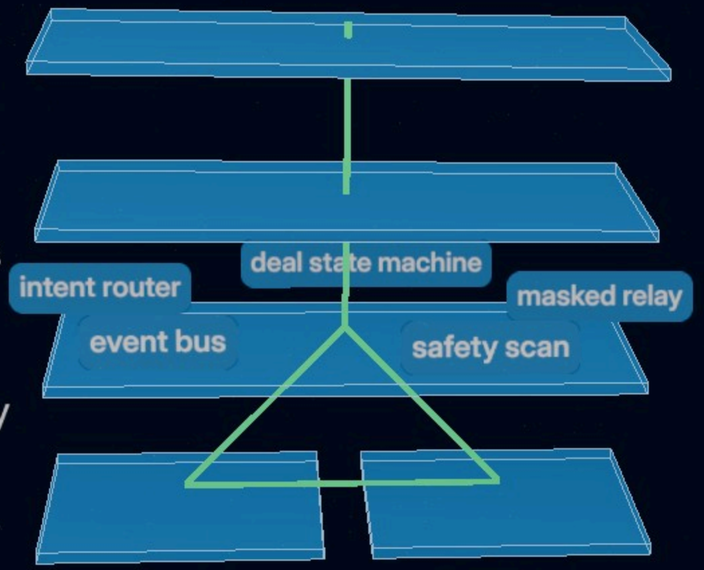
plain-code scan on every relay, no model in the hot path · Gemini vision moderates every photo, fail-closed

How it's built

iPhone
iMessage is the whole UI · ❤️ = yes

Photon Spectrum
real iMessage in and out · 1:1 lines

Karl server
Bun · TypeScript · Hono · Railway



`trace: a seller ❤️s their draft`

01 ❤️ arrives over Photon
deduped by message id

02 message id → intent: publish
tapbacks are buttons · no LLM call

03 Gemini embeds the listing
768-d vector, stored in Tiger Data

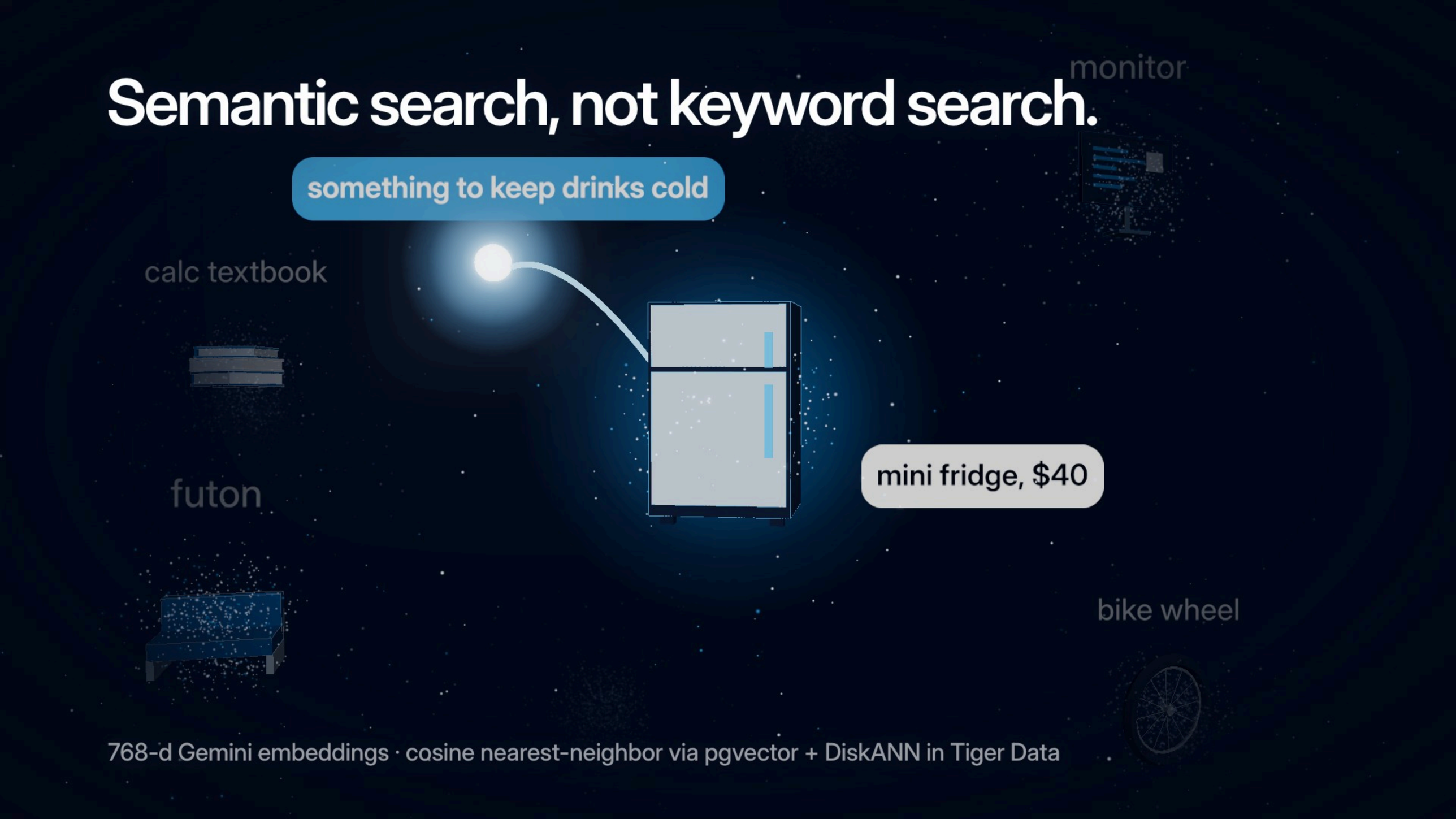
04 search runs in reverse
listing → every saved want · DiskANN

05 match_found on the event bus
Karl texts the buyer first

The LLM interprets. Deterministic code commits.

18 typed tools · Gemini never writes SQL or moves money · keyword fallback if Gemini is down

Semantic search, not keyword search.



768-d Gemini embeddings · cosine nearest-neighbor via pgvector + DiskANN in Tiger Data

Live at UNC right now



straight from our dashboard · Timescale continuous aggregate in Tiger Data

What's next

01 UNC email verification

02 Move-out week launch

03 Ratings

04 More campuses

tickets only if UNC policy changes





Text Karl.

the campus marketplace that lives in iMessage

scan to sign up